Actual disinvestment capital receipts came to only Rs 50,304 crore, resulting in a shortfall of Rs 65,000 crore. The disinvestment programme simply flopped in 2019–20, turning out one of its worst performances in many years.

The government had successfully achieved projected targets of disinvestment receipts in financial years 2017–18 and 2018–19. An amount of Rs 1,00,045 crore was received in 2017–18 and Rs 85,045 crore in 2018–19 against a target of Rs 1 lakh crore and Rs 80,000 crore, respectively. Encouraged by this performance in the previous two years, the government had projected an all-time high disinvestment receipt target of Rs 1.05 lakh crore for 2019–20.

The government received an amount of Rs 88,970 crore in 2017–18 from disinvestment comprising Rs 2802 crore of the face value of shares sold and Rs 86,168 crore of premium received on disinvestment of government equity holdings. An amount of Rs 11,075 crore was also received from other miscellaneous assets like evacuee property and treated as disinvestment receipts. In total, disinvestment proceeds at Rs 1,00,005 crore exceeded Rs 1 lakh crore for the first time in India’s history.

The Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM), which is responsible for disinvestment and strategic disinvestment, made a total of thirty transactions during 2017–18, generating a disinvestment receipt of Rs 40,231 crore in the process. The largest proceeds accrued when CPSE shares of Rs 14,500 crore were sold as part of the Bharat 22 Exchange Traded Fund (ETF). NTPC’s 6.63 per cent equity stake was sold in the single biggest individual disinvestment at Rs 9117 crore. Other major transactions included 10 per cent stake sale in the Initial Public Offer (IPO) of Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd which generated Rs 4055 crore, 2.52 per cent of sale of National Mineral Development Corporation, now NMDC Ltd equity at Rs 1223 crore and 9.2 per cent stake sale of NALCO at Rs 1192 crore. The IPO of HUDCO yielded Rs 1207 crore. A few buyback